

Welcome Back!

Putting It All Together

English Básico A1 · Beginner 1

● Friday, July 24, 2026 · Day 8

● Grammar Review · Phonics · Reading

Warm-Up!

Let's remember yesterday

1

This is ____ (I) house.

2

The book is ____ (in/on/at) the table.

3

He lives ____ (in/on/at) Panama City.

Today's Agenda

Putting It All Together

01

Warm-up

02

"To Be" vs. Present Simple

03

Phonics Corner: Vowels + Magic E

04

Reading: Sofia's Home

No new grammar today — we're connecting what you already know in new ways.

SECTION 1

"To Be" vs. Present Simple

Two systems — when do we use which?

Linking Verbs vs. Action Verbs

Definition

This is the real reason "to be" and Present Simple work differently: they belong to two different families of verbs.

Linking Verb

Connects ("links") the subject to a description. No action happens — it just tells us what something IS or is LIKE.

"To be" is the main linking verb in English.

She is tall. He is a doctor.

Action Verb

Shows what the subject DOES — a real action or activity that happens.

Live, work, have, study, eat... are all action verbs.

She works. He studies English.

"To Be" vs. Present Simple

"To Be"

Connects the subject to a description — no action. am / is / are + adjective or noun.

She is nice. He is a teacher.

Present Simple

Describes actions and habits — something you DO. Action verb (+S for he/she/it).

She works. He lives in a city.

Common Mistakes — the two systems get mixed up:

✗ She is works.

✓ She works.

an action verb never needs "is" with it

✗ She nice.

✓ She is nice.

adjectives need a linking verb — that's "to be"

✗ He is has a car.

✓ He has a car.

"have/has" is already a full verb — don't add "is"

✗ They live happy.

✓ They are happy.

never use "am/is/are" directly with a base action verb in the present simple

Practice: Choose the Correct Form

"To Be" or the action verb?

1. She _____ (is / works) in an office.

2. He _____ (is / has) a big house.

3. They _____ (are / live) happy.

4. My mom _____ (is / studies) English.

5. The kitchen _____ (is / has) small.

6. We _____ (are / eat) breakfast at 7.

7. My brother _____ (is / plays) soccer on Sundays.

8. The house _____ (is / has) a big garden.

9. I _____ (am / work) in a hospital.

10. She _____ (is / speaks) English very well.

Practice: Answers ✓

1. She works in an office.

2. He has a big house.

3. They are happy.

4. My mom studies English.

5. The kitchen is small.

6. We eat breakfast at 7.

7. My brother plays soccer on Sundays.

8. The house has a big garden.

9. I work in a hospital.

10. She speaks English very well.

SECTION 2

Phonics Corner

Vowel sounds and Magic E — reading superpowers.

What Are Vowel Sounds?

Definition

Every English vowel (a, e, i, o, u) can make two different sounds: a SHORT sound and a LONG sound.

SHORT

A quick sound. Usually happens when the vowel sits between two consonants (a "closed" syllable): C-V-C.

cat, bed, sit, hot, cup

LONG

The vowel "says its own name." Happens with a silent E, two vowels together, or when a word ends in the vowel.

cake, tree, kite, go, blue

What Are Vowel Sounds?

A woman with long dark hair, smiling, wearing a grey short-sleeved top. She is holding a large, orange, 3D-style letter 'P' in her right hand. A small black lavalier microphone is clipped to her top.

**SHORT &
LONG
VOWELS**

ANNIE RUDEN MS CCC-SLP

Short Vowel Sounds

Rule: usually one vowel between two consonants (C-V-C) — the vowel stays short.

A

/æ/

cat, hat, map, bag

E

/ɛ/

bed, pen, red, ten

I

/ɪ/

sit, big, pin, fish

O

/ɒ/

hot, dog, box, top

U

/ʌ/

cup, sun, bus, run

Long Vowel Sounds

Rule: the vowel "says its own name" — happens with silent E, vowel pairs, or open syllables.

A

/eɪ/

cake, name, gate, day

E

/i:/

he, we, see, tree

I

/aɪ/

bike, time, kite, my

O

/oʊ/

home, nose, rope, go

U

/u:, ju:/

blue, June, use, cute

💡 Long U has two sounds: "oo" (blue, June) or "yoo" (use, cute) — both are correct, it depends on the word.

Magic E: The Rule

The Rule

Consonant + Vowel + Consonant + silent E → the E is silent, and it makes the vowel say its long sound.

Pattern: C - V - C - e (example: k-i-t-e)

Short Vowel	+ Magic E	New Sound
kit	kite	long I
cub	cube	long U
hat	hate	long A
rip	ripe	long I
not	note	long O
pin	pine	long I

🌟 It's called "Magic" because the E doesn't make its own sound — it reaches back over the consonant to change the vowel before it.

SECTION 3

Reading

Sofia's Home — everything you know, in one story.

Vocabulary Before You Read

Two new words you'll see in today's reading:

cozy

warm and comfortable — acogedor

My living room is small, but it's cozy.

visit

to go see someone — visitar

On Sundays, we visit my grandmother.

Reading: Sofia's Home

My name is Sofia. I am 28 years old, and I am a teacher. I live in an apartment in Panama City. My apartment has a small kitchen and a cozy living room. My husband's name is Carlos. He is tall and funny. He works at a hospital. We have a dog. Her name is Luna. Luna is small and happy. In the morning, I have breakfast at home. Then I go to work. My mom lives in a village. She has a big garden. On Sundays, we visit her.

Reading Comprehension

True or False:

1. Sofia is a doctor.

2. Sofia lives in an apartment.

3. Carlos is short.

4. Luna is a cat.

Fill in the Blank:

5. Sofia _____ (be) 28 years old.

6. Carlos _____ (work) at a hospital.

7. Sofia's mom _____ (live) in a village.

8. They visit her mom _____ (on/in/at) Sundays.

Reading Comprehension: Answers ✓

1. False — she is a teacher.

2. True.

3. False — he is tall.

4. False — Luna is a dog.

5. is

6. works

7. lives

8. on

Great job today!

Today we connected everything: grammar, phonics, and reading.

No homework, no Kahoot today. Optional spelling practice in Classroom.

Have a great weekend!

See you next class!